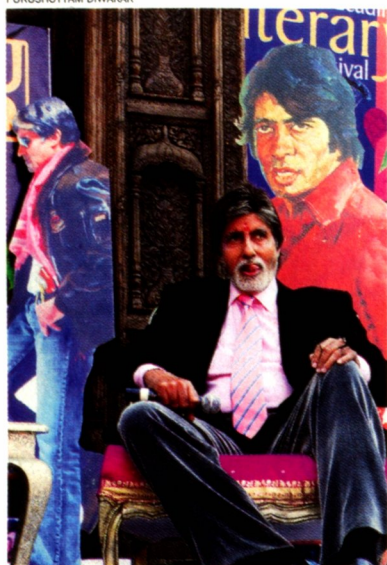


PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



BACHCHAN AT THE FESTIVAL

JAIPUR | All Lit Up

The pen and ink posse gets a bit jittery when movie stars show up at their dos, like when Aamir Khan made an appearance at the third Jaipur Literature Festival last year. So this year in Jaipur, Amitabh Bachchan had his answer ready. A discussion on *Bachchanalia*, a book dedicated to his luminary self, he said proved that Bollywood had a place in literary festivals. Er... if you insist. The rest of the gathering of authors, publishers and general festival-crashers discussed Oscar-nominated film *Slumdog Millionaire* endlessly, with Governor S.K. Singh being asked to arrive early if he wanted to attend the special screening. Vikram Seth languidly sipped red wine during his interaction with his audience and annoyed a few. Festival producer Sanjoy Roy could only beam, "People think it's sexy to be here." **by Rohit Parihar**

160

writers from 16 countries took part in the Jaipur Literature Festival 2009.

THE CATCH-A-TIGER OPERATION IN PROGRESS



LUCKNOW | Man-Eater Muddle

At a time when the state Government is chanting the development mantra, a desperate chase for a two-and-a-half year-old tiger has kept forest officials in Lucknow on their toes. For 60 days, six elephants, nearly 250 forest officials, hundreds of villagers and sniffer dogs have been trying to spot the tiger that they say has already claimed the lives of three human beings and is a danger to both man and beast. The tiger strayed out of the Terai jungle around Pilibhit and headed towards Lucknow a month ago.

The state Government had declared the big cat a man-eater and issued a shoot-at-sight order, a decision which was snubbed by the National Tiger Conservation Authority. It was then decided that the tiger would be caught alive. Later the Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court ordered the state Government to issue fresh instructions. The Opposition has ridiculed the Mayawati Government saying, "If it can't catch a tiger, how will it catch a terrorist?"

by Subhash Mishra

TECH STOP

Now You See It...

GOING CROSS-EYED with SMSes? Fed up of using a PDA stylus or typing out an e-mail on the Blackberry? The Virtual Laser Keyboard may or may not address your individual gripe but it is truly the stuff straight out of sci-fi. Get your head around this: the laser keyboard is not a real keyboard to begin with. It's a hologram, a projected display of a keyboard that is



beamed (sorry, couldn't resist) onto any flat, non-reflective surface—like a table top. The keyboard is projected from a compact 9x3.5x2 cm blue-tooth compatible device the size of a Zippo lighter which has a battery life of two hours. Once the QWERTY keyboard lights up on the work surface, hit the keys on the laser projection and the command will be conveyed back to your computer or PDA and even mobile phone.

THE VIRTUAL KEYBOARD IS A HOLOGRAPHIC DISPLAY OF A KEYBOARD THAT IS BEAMED ON ANY FLAT SURFACE